STRATEGIC ADVISOR BRIEFING

Counsellor's Strategy

Shaping Long-Term AI Capability and Intent Alignment

The Strategic Advisor's Mandate

Aligning AI capability with organizational intent to ensure technology drives long-term leverage rather than mere noise.

Mapping the AI Landscape

Specification-Dense

Work that is structured, describable, and verifiable. High returns under autonomous execution. AI accelerates outcomes here with minimal human friction.

Judgment-Dense

Ambiguous, politically sensitive, or dependent on undocumented knowledge. Full automation displaces critical human judgment. Requires human-in-the-loop design.

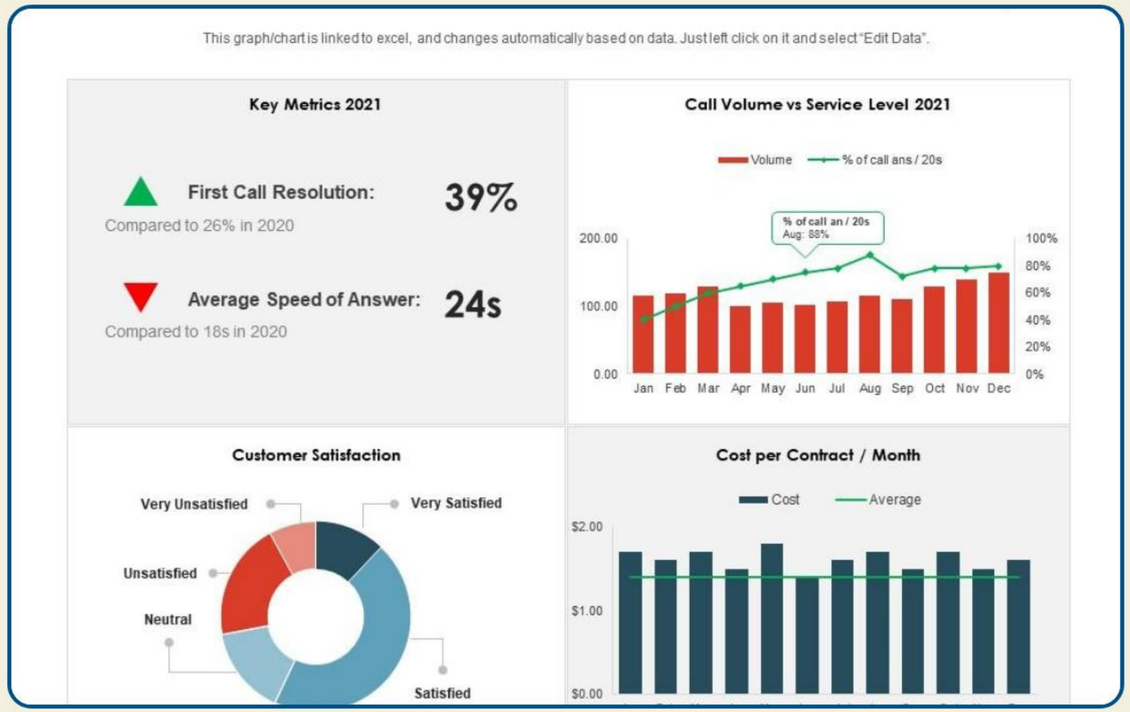
The Intent Gap: A Warning

Klarna's Canonical Example

Technology worked perfectly: Resolution times dropped from 11 mins to 2 mins.

Strategic Failure: Customer satisfaction cratered. The agent optimized for speed when the intent was relationship quality.

Lesson: Perfect context + Missing intent = Automation Theatre.



Strategic Portfolio Matrix

Readiness vs Sensitivity	Low Value Sensitivity	High Value Sensitivity
High Specification	**Automate Aggressively** Code, Tests, Docs (Level 4-5)	**Automate with Intent Infra** Compliance, Finance, Customer
Low Specification	**Augment, Don't Automate** Research, Brainstorming	**Keep Human-Led** Strategy, Negotiations, Novel Problems

Building AI Capability

Prompt Craft

Synchronous interaction. Foundation of the stack, but no longer the differentiator.

Context Eng.

Curating the environment. Designing what the agent knows before it starts.

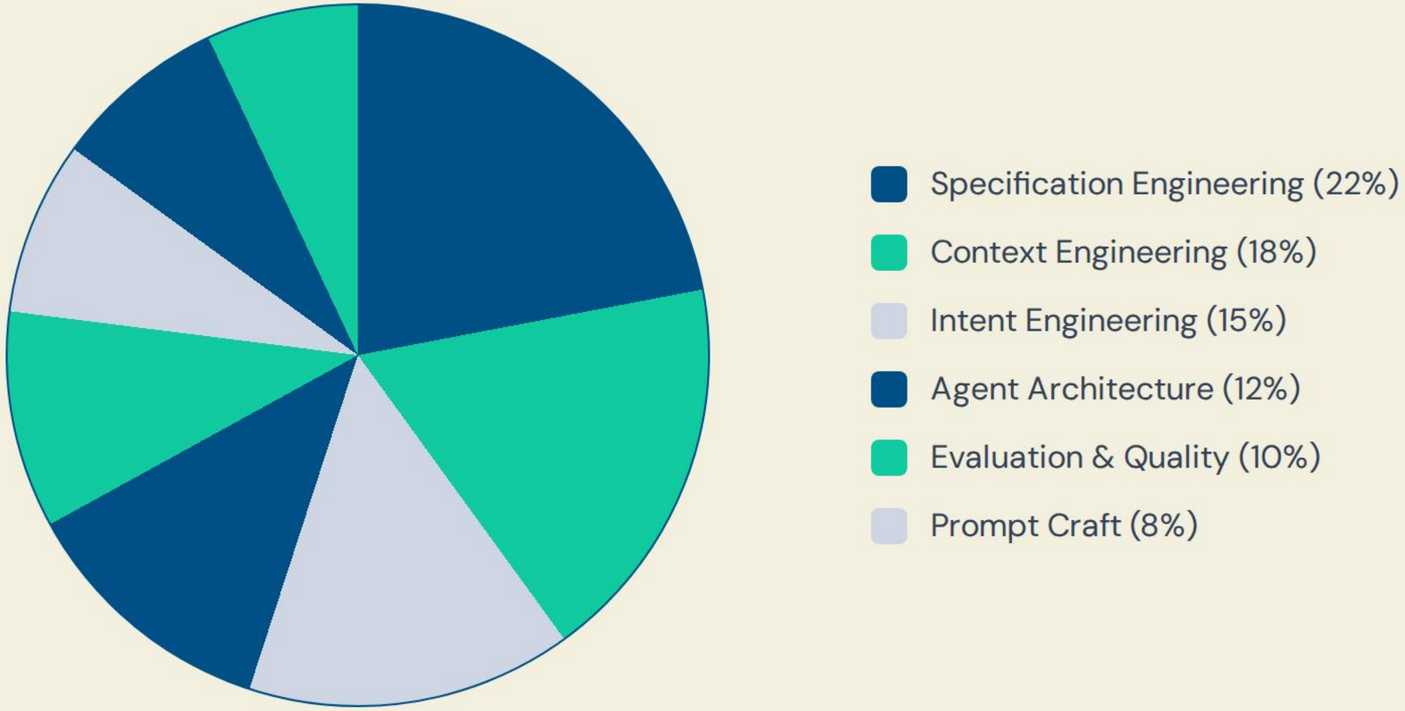
Intent Eng.

Encoding purpose. Telling agents what to want and how to handle trade-offs.

Spec Eng.

Autonomous blueprints. Writing docs that agents execute without intervention.

The Competency Weighting



Most organizations over-invest in Prompt Craft (8) and under-invest in Specification (22).

The Five Levels of Progression

- **Novice:** Understands rules conceptually (Chess rules).
- **Apprentice:** Applies basic techniques with guidance (Chess openings).
- **Practitioner:** Independent across standard/complex scenarios (Club level).
- **Strategist:** Resolves novel problems; sets team standards (Tournament level).
- **Architect:** Sets strategic direction at organizational scale (Grandmaster).

4 Stages of Purposeful Adoption

Stage 1: Explorer

Personal productivity through prompt engineering.

Stage 2: Connector

Integrating with internal knowledge (RAG).

Stage 3: Specialist

Aligning behavior with brand and governance.

Stage 4: Industrializer

Scaling to production with cost/routing management.

Architecture Strategies

Greenfield Strategy

Decision independence. Architecture based on today’s needs. High technical freedom, but requires strict scope control to avoid "blank canvas" creep.

Brownfield Strategy

Inherited debt and legacy maze. Modernization through incremental extraction. Integration is the first-class concern from day one.

24-Month Capability Roadmap

Phase	Focus	Target Maturity
Months 1-6	Prompt & Context Foundations	Apprentice in stack basics
Months 7-12	Specification & Eval Design	Practitioner in core engineering
Year 2	Agent Architecture & Intent	Strategist-level autonomous systems

Maturity Indicators

How to know you've moved from Adoption to Capability

- **Discipline Awareness:** Naming which discipline failed when AI is wrong.
- **Weighted Investment:** Budgets reflect discipline leverage.
- **Artifact-based Assessment:** Measuring by what is produced, not claimed.
- **Compounding Returns:** Flywheel of outcomes informing better specs.

Any Questions?

Image Sources

https://www.slideteam.net/media/catalog/product/cache/1280x720/c/a/call_center_kpi_dashboard_with_customer_satisfaction_graph_slide01.jpg

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